

messages logged to the console, which is incidentally much better than making a call to `alert()`, since it does not halt program execution.

Newer browsers now have a native implementation of JSON to speed up parsing and serializing. The native JSON object is specified as part of the ECMAScript 5 standard covering the next generation of the JavaScript language.

Browser Support

An important question to address here is how to identify if your browser supports that HTML5 feature – be it canvas, video or form attributes.

When your browser renders a web page, it constructs a Document Object Model (DOM), a collection of objects that represent the HTML elements on the page. Every element — every `<p>`, every `<div>`, every `<span>` — is represented in the DOM by a different object.

All DOM objects share a set of common properties, but some objects have more than others. In browsers that support HTML5 features, certain objects will have unique properties. A quick peek at the DOM will tell you which features are supported.

There are four basic techniques for detecting whether a browser supports a particular feature. From simplest to most complex:

1. Check if a certain property exists on a global object (such as `window` or `navigator`).
2. Create an element, then check if a certain property exists on that element.
3. Create an element, check if a certain method exists on that element, then call the method and check the value it returns.
4. Create an element, set a property to a certain value, then check if the property has retained its value

For detection of HTML5 features your best tool is Modernizr. Modernizr is a small JavaScript library that detects the availability of native implementations for next-generation web technologies, i.e. features that stem from the HTML5 and CSS3 specifications. Many of these features are already implemented in at least one major browser (most of them in two or more), and what Modernizr does is, very simply, tell you whether the current browser has this feature natively implemented or not. 